



INDIAN LAW & DEALMAKING · 1 AUGUST 2026

Five moves shaping the board now.

- › SEBI bars Goenka and Chandra one year
- › NCLT clears record 78 IBC plans in Q1
- › SC tightens specific performance readiness test
- › ED restores over sixty-three thousand crore rupees
- › India FY26 M&A crosses one hundred twenty-three billion

SWIPE →



LANE · REG

01 / 05

SEBI penalises ZEEL and bans Goenka and Chandra

On 31 July 2026 SEBI imposed a one-year market bar on Punit Goenka and Subhash Chandra and levied a total penalty of ₹1.48 crore on ZEEL and the two promoters for governance lapses and undisclosed related-party transactions. ZEEL faced a ₹30 lakh penalty and a two-month market ban while Goenka and Chandra were fined ₹58 lakh and ₹60 lakh respectively.

THE READ

Markets will price promoter governance risk higher and lenders will tighten covenants around related-party disclosures. Boards should audit RPT protocols and pre-clearance workflows before the next earnings cycle.



LANE · COURT

02 / 05

NCLT approves record seventy-eight IBC plans in Q1

On 13 July 2026 the National Company Law Tribunal reported approval of 78 resolution plans in Q1 April to June 2026 involving ₹5,517.66 crore which marks the highest first-quarter performance since the IBC began. Cumulative approvals now total 1,628 plans worth ₹4.78 lakh crore.

THE READ

Resolution velocity is improving and distressed asset prices will firm as bidder confidence rises. Lenders and sponsors should accelerate plan submissions and lock valuation windows before competition intensifies.



LANE · COURT

03 / 05

SC narrows specific performance to continuous readiness

On 31 July 2026 the Supreme Court held that specific performance under Section 20 of the Specific Relief Act cannot be granted where the plaintiff fails to show continuous readiness and willingness and approaches the court with unclean or contradictory conduct. The ruling is precedent-setting for commercial contract and asset purchase disputes.

THE READ

Buy-side counsel must document readiness through escrow funding and performance notices before filing. Sellers gain leverage to resist specific performance where buyer conduct is inconsistent or delayed.



LANE · REG

04 / 05

ED reports sixty-three thousand crore restored under PMLA

On 23 July 2026 the Enforcement Directorate reported restoration of ₹63,142.65 crore in assets to victims and legitimate claimants under PMLA including major restitutions in the Vijay Mallya Nirav Modi and Mehul Choksi cases. The data covers multiple high-profile PMLA proceedings and represents the latest comprehensive enforcement update as of 1 August 2026.

THE READ

Restitution momentum strengthens creditor recovery prospects and raises the stakes for early cooperation in PMLA proceedings. Compliance teams should map exposure to attached assets and prepare claim documentation ahead of adjudication orders.



India FY26 M&A value surges to one hundred twenty-three billion

On 3 May 2026 EY and Grant Thornton reported India's M&A market recorded \$123.8 billion in total deal value in FY26 up 18 percent year-on-year driven by mega cross-border transactions including Sun Pharma–Organon at \$11.75 billion Tata Motors–Iveco at €3.8 billion and Emirates NBD–RBL Bank at around \$3 billion. The total reflects the latest full-year synthesis as of 1 August 2026.

THE READ

Capital is abundant for quality assets and cross-border structures will command premium valuations. Sponsors should prepare auction-ready diligence packs and pre-negotiate regulatory clearances to capture deal windows.



THE THROUGH-LINE

The through-line is accountability and velocity. SEBI's ZEEL order and the Supreme Court's readiness standard tighten the gate on governance and contract enforcement. At the same time NCLT's record IBC approvals ED's large-scale restitution and FY26's deal surge show faster resolution and stronger capital flows for compliant and well-prepared parties.





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